Modern Horizons 3 Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

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Dataset Snapshot

This run on Modern Horizons 3 uses 163,693 unique deck builds and 767,772 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 11 learned archetypes. Card win rates are games-in-hand (GIH) win rates; an archetype's win rate is over all of its games. The best-performing large shells are Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith, Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible, Azorius | Riddle Gate Gargoyle / Emissary of Soulfire, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and standalone bombs.

How to Read This Report

- **Coreness** measures how central a card is to an archetype: played in many of its decks, characteristic of it, and connected to the rest of the deck. Cards are grouped into Core, Support and Periphery rings. A core card may carry a tag: **signature** (in bold: played in at least 15% of this archetype's decks and in at most one other archetype at that rate) or *staple* (at least 25% of this archetype's decks and at least 15% in three or more archetypes); untagged core cards are neither.
- **Play rate** is the share of the archetype's decks that play at least one copy.
- **Bombs** are cards that are strong on their own. A bomb's **lift** compares, within the decks that play it, the win rate when the card is in hand with the win rate when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, and is shrunk across archetypes; it is shown in percentage points (pp). Bombs are listed whatever ring they sit in: core and support bombs keep their ring on the site, and only bombs that would otherwise be peripheral go to the bomb island beside the rings.
- A **synergy pair** wins more often when both cards are drawn than their separate effects predict (games-in-hand, adjusted for game length and play/draw). The effect λ is an interaction log-odds, shown as a percentage change in the odds of winning with its 95% confidence interval. Pairs are tested with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control: *verified* means $q \leq 0.10$, *tentative* means $q \leq 0.25$. Few pairs pass; an absent pair means "not detectable with this data", not "no synergy".

- **Payoff** and **engine** roles are decided by synergy arrows only: the synergy pairs (verified or tentative) whose direction is significant. In such a pair the arrow points from the payoff, the card that wins more when drawn without its partner, to the engine it rewards; a card whose arrows mostly point out of it is a payoff, one whose arrows mostly point into it an engine. The arrow reflects each card's standalone strength within the pair, not a direction of the synergy itself. Played-together links carry the same arrow on the site as context only; they do not set roles.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	21,778	106,952	58.59%	Conduit Goblin, Hexgold Slith, Solstice Zealot, Smelted Chargebug, Mandibular Kite
Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	21,585	107,876	58.04%	Writhing Chrysalis, Glimpse the Impossible, Voidpouncer, Malevolent Rumble, Eldrazi Repurposer
Azorius | Riddle Gate Gargoyle / Emissary of Soulfire	9,491	44,666	56.00%	Riddle Gate Gargoyle, Emissary of Soulfire, Tune the Narrative, Solstice Zealot, Aether Spike
Selesnya | Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxiliary	13,986	66,495	55.17%	Faithful Watchdog, Aerie Auxiliary, Nyxborn Unicorn, Golden-Tail Trainer, Dog Umbra
Dimir | Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	15,852	72,783	54.64%	Sneaky Snacker, Kami of Jealous Thirst, Eviscerator's Insight, Mindless Conscription, Breathe Your Last
Jeskai | Emissary of Soulfire / Riddle Gate Gargoyle	7,063	31,495	53.74%	Riddle Gate Gargoyle, Cyclops Superconductor, Conduit Goblin, Emissary of Soulfire, Tune the Narrative
Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	27,655	130,600	53.68%	Snapping Voidcraw, Sage of the Unknowable, Drownyard Lurker, Petrifying Meddler, Unfathomable Truths
Izzet | Cyclops Superconductor / Tune the Narrative	8,771	39,042	53.19%	Cyclops Superconductor, Tune the Narrative, Aether Spike, Tempest Harvester, Electrozoa
Rakdos Zombies | Cranial Ram / Refurbished Familiar	13,259	59,101	53.14%	Cranial Ram, Refurbished Familiar, Drossclaw, Retrofitted Transmogrant, Sarpadian Simulacrum

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Golgari | Expanding Ooze / Cursed Wombat	14,685	66,223	52.48%	Expanding Ooze, Cursed Wombat, Dreamdrinker Vampire, Wither and Bloom, Fetid Gargantua
Orzhov | Obstinate Gargoyle / Ondu Knotmaster	9,568	42,539	52.47%	Obstinate Gargoyle, Ondu Knotmaster, Dreamdrinker Vampire, Wither and Bloom, Breathe Your Last

2 Core of Each Archetype

The core ring of each archetype, most central first, with the share of the archetype's decks that play each card and its tag where it has one: **signature** (in bold) or staple. The second line lists the archetype's bombs, whatever ring they sit in: cards that are strong on their own, with their lift (in-hand vs in-library win rate within the decks that play them, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes) and their games in hand.

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Simic Eldrazi 27,655 decks	**Snapping Voidcraw** (64%, signature), **Sage of the Unknowable** (49%, signature), Petrifying Meddler (54%, staple), Drownyard Lurker (52%, staple), Warped Tusker (45%, staple), **Kozilek's Unsealing** (27%, signature), Unfathomable Truths (49%, staple), Malevolent Rumble (48%, staple), Eldrazi Repurposer (49%, staple), **Corrupted Shapeshifter** (25%, signature) *Bombs:* Writhing Chrysalis (+9.2 pp, 29,735 games); Crabomination (+7.5 pp, 662 games); Tamiyo, Inquisitive Student (+7.0 pp, 2,075 games); Emrakul, the World Anew (+6.8 pp, 2,910 games)
Boros 21,778 decks	Solstice Zealot (56%, staple), **Conduit Goblin** (83%, signature), Smelted Chargebug (60%, staple), Mandibular Kite (58%, staple), Nyxborn Unicorn (50%, staple), Hexgold Slith (61%, staple), Thraben Charm (54%, staple), Aerie Auxiliary (60%, staple), Inspired Inventor (53%, staple), Jolted Awake (33%, staple) *Bombs:* Guide of Souls (+12.7 pp, 5,411 games); Amped Raptor (+10.5 pp, 16,311 games); Ajani, Nacatl Pariah (+9.8 pp, 2,271 games); Ocelot Pride (+9.6 pp, 2,195 games)
Gruul Eldrazi 21,585 decks	**Voidpouncer** (51%, signature), Glimpse the Impossible (59%, staple), Malevolent Rumble (57%, staple), Horrific Assault (51%, staple), Basking Broodscale (48%, staple), Nightshade Dryad (47%, staple), **Titans' Vanguard** (35%, signature), Warped Tusker (42%, staple), Colossal Dreadmask (39%, staple), Eldrazi Repurposer (53%, staple) *Bombs:* Writhing Chrysalis (+12.4 pp, 41,055 games); Guide of Souls (+8.2 pp, 486 games); Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury (+7.3 pp, 616 games); Kozilek's Command (+5.5 pp, 3,159 games)

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Dimir 15,852 decks	Eviscerator's Insight (60%, staple), **Sneaky Snacker** (85%, signature), **Kami of Jealous Thirst** (61%, signature), Breathe Your Last (57%, staple), Accursed Marauder (55%, staple), Scurrilous Sentry (46%, staple), **Mindless Conscription** (43%, signature), Deem Inferior (57%, staple), **Horrid Shadowspinner** (44%, signature), Wither and Bloom (56%, staple) *Bombs:* Crabomination (+10.6 pp, 4,776 games); Psychic Frog (+7.8 pp, 9,717 games); Tamiyo, Inquisitive Student (+7.3 pp, 2,457 games); Guide of Souls (+6.5 pp, 355 games)
Golgari 14,685 decks	**Expanding Ooze** (72%, signature), Dreamdrinker Vampire (49%, staple), **Cursed Wombat** (47%, signature), Breathe Your Last (50%, staple), Temperamental Oozewagg (45%, staple), Fetid Gargantua (45%, staple), Evolution Witness (50%, staple), Accursed Marauder (43%, staple), Scurrilous Sentry (36%, staple), Gravedig (36%, staple) *Bombs:* Crabomination (+9.9 pp, 3,476 games); Writhing Chrysalis (+6.7 pp, 7,016 games); Nadu, Winged Wisdom (+5.6 pp, 1,276 games)
Selesnya 13,986 decks	Nyxborn Unicorn (52%, staple), **Golden-Tail Trainer** (35%, signature), **Faithful Watchdog** (83%, signature), Aerie Auxiliary (61%, staple), Mandibular Kite (51%, staple), Temperamental Oozewagg (47%, staple), Dog Umbra (50%, staple), Nyxborn Hydra (47%, staple), Thraben Charm (51%, staple), Evolution Witness (44%, staple) *Bombs:* Guide of Souls (+11.1 pp, 2,495 games); Ocelot Pride (+9.8 pp, 1,583 games); Ajani, Nacatl Pariah (+7.5 pp, 1,124 games); Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury (+7.3 pp, 422 games)
Rakdos Zombies 13,259 decks	**Cranial Ram** (83%, signature), Retrofitted Transmogrant (59%, staple), **Drossclaw** (53%, signature), Refurbished Familiar (73%, staple), **Sarpadian Simulacrum** (46%, signature), Smelted Chargebug (51%, staple), Molten Gatekeeper (54%, staple), **Furnace Hellkite** (33%, signature), **Arcbound Condor** (35%, signature), **Etherium Pteramander** (38%, signature) *Bombs:* Crabomination (+11.5 pp, 3,411 games); Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury (+7.4 pp, 258 games); Marionette Apprentice (+7.0 pp, 9,301 games); Refurbished Familiar (+6.1 pp, 24,143 games)
Orzhov 9,568 decks	Dreamdrinker Vampire (47%, staple), **Obstinate Gargoyle** (69%, signature), **Ondu Knotmaster** (44%, signature), Breathe Your Last (52%, staple), Accursed Marauder (47%, staple), Aerie Auxiliary (50%, staple), Nyxborn Unicorn (40%, staple), Thraben Charm (42%, staple), Mandibular Kite (45%, staple), Retrofitted Transmogrant (37%, staple) *Bombs:* Crabomination (+11.4 pp, 2,246 games); Ocelot Pride (+10.4 pp, 1,058 games); Guide of Souls (+9.9 pp, 1,817 games); Ajani, Nacatl Pariah (+8.8 pp, 972 games)
Azorius 9,491 decks	**Emissary of Soulfire** (46%, signature), Tune the Narrative (48%, staple), Solstice Zealot (50%, staple), Electrozoa (37%, staple), Aerie Auxiliary (56%, staple), Aether Spike (47%, staple), Hexgold Slith (47%, staple), Tempest Harvester (48%, staple), Thraben Charm (50%, staple), Roil Cartographer (32%, staple) *Bombs:* Guide of Souls (+15.0 pp, 2,745 games); Ocelot Pride (+10.8 pp, 934 games); Satya, Aetherflux Genius (+8.4 pp, 803 games); Ajani, Nacatl Pariah (+7.6 pp, 894 games)

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Izzet 8,771 decks	Aether Spike (63%, staple), Tune the Narrative (70%, staple), Electrozoa (45%, staple), Cyclops Superconductor (79%, signature), Roil Cartographer (39%, staple), Izzet Generatorium (36%, signature), Tempest Harvester (62%, staple), Thriving Skyclaw (38%, staple), Bespoke Battlewagon (38%, staple), Serum Visionary (50%, staple) *Bombs:* Satya, Aetherflux Genius (+8.1 pp, 911 games); Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury (+7.8 pp, 343 games); Wheel of Potential (+7.5 pp, 230 games); Amped Raptor (+7.4 pp, 6,560 games)
Jeskai 7,063 decks	Conduit Goblin (59%, signature), Tune the Narrative (52%, staple), Riddle Gate Gargoyle (78%, signature), Cyclops Superconductor (67%, signature), Aether Spike (41%, staple), Izzet Generatorium (32%, signature), Bespoke Battlewagon (33%, staple), Tempest Harvester (41%, staple), Scurry of Gremlins (40%, signature), Emissary of Soulfire (40%, signature) *Bombs:* Guide of Souls (+13.3 pp, 1,554 games); Amped Raptor (+11.3 pp, 4,562 games); Ocelot Pride (+9.4 pp, 397 games); Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury (+9.1 pp, 817 games)

3 What Defines the Best Shells

Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith

This cluster contains 21,778 decks across 106,952 games and posts a baseline win rate of 58.59%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is Solstice Zealot (56% of decks), Conduit Goblin (83% of decks), Smelted Chargebug (60% of decks), Mandibular Kite (58% of decks), Nyxborn Unicorn (50% of decks). Its defining signposts are Conduit Goblin, Hexgold Slith, Solstice Zealot, Smelted Chargebug, Mandibular Kite, Scurry of Gremlins.

Bombs that win on their own here: Guide of Souls (+12.7 pp), Amped Raptor (+10.5 pp), Ajani, Nacatl Pariah (+9.8 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 10 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 2 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is Guide of Souls + Solstice Zealot: +40% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+19, +64]%, 1,174 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards that win more when drawn than their partners) are Conduit Goblin, Unstable Amulet and the engines they reward are Aether Revolt.

Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible

This cluster contains 21,585 decks across 107,876 games and posts a baseline win rate of 58.04%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is Voidpouncer (51% of decks), Glimpse the Impossible (59% of decks), Malevolent Rumble (57% of decks), Horrific Assault (51% of decks), Basking Broodscale (48% of decks). Its defining signposts are Writhing Chrysalis, Glimpse the Impossible, Voidpouncer, Malevolent Rumble, Eldrazi Repurposer, Horrific Assault.

Bombs that win on their own here: Writhing Chrysalis (+12.4 pp), Guide of Souls (+8.2 pp), Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury (+7.3 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 6 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 13 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is Path of Annihilation + Warped Tusker: +24% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+12, +37]%, 2,384 games).

Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards that win more when drawn than their partners) are Path of Annihilation, Horrific Assault, Nightshade Dryad and the engines they reward are Basking Broodscale, Molten Gatekeeper, Sarpadian Simulacrum.

Azorius | Riddle Gate Gargoyle / Emissary of Soulfire

This cluster contains 9,491 decks across 44,666 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.00%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is Emissary of Soulfire (46% of decks), Tune the Narrative (48% of decks), Solstice Zealot (50% of decks), Electrozoa (37% of decks), Aerie Auxiliary (56% of decks). Its defining signposts are Riddle Gate Gargoyle, Emissary of Soulfire, Tune the Narrative, Solstice Zealot, Aether Spike, Electrozoa.

Bombs that win on their own here: Guide of Souls (+15.0 pp), Ocelot Pride (+10.8 pp), Satya, Aetherflux Genius (+8.4 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 3 are verified synergies (BH q $\leq$ 0.10) and 7 tentative (q $\leq$ 0.25). The strongest verified pair is Hexgold Slith + Roil Cartographer: +29% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+13, +47]%, 1,511 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards that win more when drawn than their partners) are Roil Cartographer.

Selesnya | Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxiliary

This cluster contains 13,986 decks across 66,495 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.17%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is Nyxborn Unicorn (52% of decks), Golden-Tail Trainer (35% of decks), Faithful Watchdog (83% of decks), Aerie Auxiliary (61% of decks), Mandibular Kite (51% of decks). Its defining signposts are Faithful Watchdog, Aerie Auxiliary, Nyxborn Unicorn, Golden-Tail Trainer, Dog Umbra, Mandibular Kite.

Bombs that win on their own here: Guide of Souls (+11.1 pp), Ocelot Pride (+9.8 pp), Ajani, Nacatl Pariah (+7.5 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 2 are verified synergies (BH q $\leq$ 0.10) and 2 tentative (q $\leq$ 0.25). The strongest verified pair is Evolution Witness + Metastatic Evangel: +29% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+15, +46]%, 1,599 games).

4 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Cards flagged as bombs in at least one archetype, whatever ring they sit in on the site, each shown in the archetype where its lift is largest. *Lift*: within the decks that play the card, the win rate when it is in hand vs when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes. *Raw lift*: the card's games-in-hand win rate minus the archetype baseline, not shrunk.

Card	Archetype	Lift	Raw lift	GIH WR	Games
Guide of Souls	Azorius	+15.0 pp	+13.3 pp	69.33%	2,745
Writhing Chrysalis	Gruul Eldrazi	+12.4 pp	+8.1 pp	66.13%	41,055
Crabomination	Rakdos Zombies	+11.5 pp	+10.7 pp	63.82%	3,411
Amped Raptor	Jeskai	+11.3 pp	+11.3 pp	64.99%	4,562
Ocelot Pride	Azorius	+10.8 pp	+11.2 pp	67.24%	934
Ajani, Nacatl Pariah	Boros	+9.8 pp	+9.9 pp	68.47%	2,271

Card	Archetype	Lift	Raw lift	GIH WR	Games
Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury	Boros	+9.1 pp	+7.8 pp	66.37%	3,423
Satya, Aetherflux Genius	Jeskai	+9.0 pp	+10.5 pp	64.23%	1,652
Psychic Frog	Dimir	+7.8 pp	+9.8 pp	64.48%	9,717
Wheel of Potential	Izzet	+7.5 pp	+2.0 pp	55.22%	230
Tamiyo, Inquisitive Student	Dimir	+7.3 pp	+9.2 pp	63.82%	2,457
Marionette Apprentice	Rakdos Zombies	+7.0 pp	+7.7 pp	60.88%	9,301
Emrakul, the World Anew	Simic Eldrazi	+6.8 pp	+7.6 pp	61.31%	2,910
Path of Annihilation	Simic Eldrazi	+6.4 pp	+8.0 pp	61.70%	17,635

5 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Solstice Zealot	Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	10.0 / 10	23.90 pp	26638
Mandibular Kite	Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	10.0 / 10	25.80 pp	29421
Warped Tusker	Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	10.0 / 10	30.14 pp	19783
Colossal Dreadmask	Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	10.0 / 10	38.13 pp	17026
Emissary of Soulfire	Azorius | Riddle Gate Gargoyle / Emissary of Soulfire	10.0 / 10	27.28 pp	10028
Evolution Witness	Selesnya | Faithful Watchdog / Aerie Auxiliary	10.0 / 10	19.49 pp	12634
Izzet Generatorium	Jeskai | Emissary of Soulfire / Riddle Gate Gargoyle	10.0 / 10	37.78 pp	4309
Bespoke Battlewagon	Jeskai | Emissary of Soulfire / Riddle Gate Gargoyle	10.0 / 10	31.07 pp	4604
Corrupted Shapeshifter	Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	10.0 / 10	36.07 pp	14113
Snapping Voidcraw	Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	10.0 / 10	20.19 pp	44033

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Imskir Iron-Eater	Rakdos Zombies | Cranial Ram / Refurbished Familiar	10.0 / 10	33.06 pp	4585
Utter Insignificance	Dimir | Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	10.0 / 10	54.42 pp	9580

6 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Cyclops Superconductor	Jeskai | Emissary of Soulfire / Riddle Gate Gargoyle	0.526	-0.37 pp	11176
Stump Stomp	Jeskai | Emissary of Soulfire / Riddle Gate Gargoyle	0.526	-1.18 pp	839
Emrakul, the World Anew	Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	0.416	7.63 pp	2910
Bespoke Battlewagon	Jeskai | Emissary of Soulfire / Riddle Gate Gargoyle	0.389	-0.09 pp	4626
Izzet Generatorium	Jeskai | Emissary of Soulfire / Riddle Gate Gargoyle	0.389	-4.65 pp	4335
Aether Revolt	Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.370	-6.10 pp	4186
Solstice Zealot	Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.335	-0.10 pp	26664
Guide of Souls	Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	0.335	11.90 pp	5411
Skittering Precursor	Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	0.333	-0.84 pp	10199
Sarpadian Simulacrum	Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	0.333	-4.19 pp	4386
Inventor's Axe	Rakdos Zombies | Cranial Ram / Refurbished Familiar	0.323	2.18 pp	6371

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Amped Raptor	Rakdos Zombies | Cranial Ram / Refurbished Familiar	0.323	6.32 pp	4364

7 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Writhing Chrysalis	Gruul Eldrazi | Writhing Chrysalis / Glimpse the Impossible	10.0 / 10	1.77 pp	common
Psychic Frog	Dimir | Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	10.0 / 10	2.87 pp	rare
Amped Raptor	Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	10.0 / 10	2.84 pp	uncommon
Path of Annihilation	Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	10.0 / 10	2.60 pp	uncommon
Guide of Souls	Boros | Conduit Goblin / Hexgold Slith	10.0 / 10	5.21 pp	rare
Malevolent Rumble	Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	9.8 / 10	1.76 pp	common
Mindless Conscription	Dimir | Sneaky Snacker / Kami of Jealous Thirst	10.0 / 10	1.50 pp	uncommon
Horrific Assault	Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	9.8 / 10	1.67 pp	common
Marionette Apprentice	Rakdos Zombies | Cranial Ram / Refurbished Familiar	10.0 / 10	2.76 pp	uncommon
Refurbished Familiar	Rakdos Zombies | Cranial Ram / Refurbished Familiar	10.0 / 10	1.30 pp	common
Nightshade Dryad	Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	9.7 / 10	1.49 pp	common
Wastescape Battlemage	Simic Eldrazi | Snapping Voidcraw / Sage of the Unknowable	9.6 / 10	1.58 pp	uncommon

8 Verified Synergy Pairs

Every pair below passed a pair-interaction test on games-in-hand data, stratified by game length and play/draw, with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control across all pairs tested in its archetype. λ is the interaction log-odds, shown as the change in the odds of winning when both cards are drawn, with its 95% confidence interval. Across all archetypes, 73 pairs are verified ($q \leq 0.10$) and 60 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$, marked †).

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	q	Pair WR	Games
Kozilek's Unsealing + Petrifying Meddler	Simic Eldrazi	+32%	[+22, +42]%	<0.001	60.42%	4,806
Emrakul, the World Anew + Path of Annihilation	Simic Eldrazi	+153%	[+90, +238]%	<0.001	82.45%	376
Kozilek's Unsealing + Warped Tusker	Simic Eldrazi	+25%	[+15, +35]%	<0.001	59.18%	3,991
Breaker of Creation + Kozilek's Unsealing	Simic Eldrazi	+31%	[+18, +45]%	<0.001	62.73%	2,090
Drownyard Lurker + Kozilek's Unsealing	Simic Eldrazi	+21%	[+12, +30]%	<0.001	58.16%	4,857
Eviscerator's Insight + Mindless Conscription	Dimir	+21%	[+13, +30]%	<0.001	65.14%	6,954
Drowner of Truth + Kozilek's Unsealing	Simic Eldrazi	+27%	[+15, +40]%	<0.001	60.30%	2,257
Kozilek's Unsealing + Writhing Chrysalis	Simic Eldrazi	+21%	[+11, +31]%	<0.001	64.24%	3,837
Drownyard Lurker + Path of Annihilation	Simic Eldrazi	+19%	[+10, +28]%	<0.001	64.41%	4,925
Eviscerator's Insight + Sneaky Snacker	Dimir	+17%	[+10, +25]%	0.001	62.27%	16,194
Horrid Shadowspinner + Sneaky Snacker	Dimir	+19%	[+10, +28]%	0.001	61.40%	10,851
Depth Defiler + Worn Powerstone	Simic Eldrazi	+33%	[+17, +51]%	0.001	64.03%	1,290
Cranial Ram + Refurbished Familiar	Rakdos Zombies	+17%	[+10, +25]%	0.002	61.56%	12,267
Corrupted Shapeshifter + Petrifying Meddler	Simic Eldrazi	+18%	[+9, +28]%	0.002	54.59%	3,759
Path of Annihilation + Warped Tusker	Simic Eldrazi	+18%	[+9, +27]%	0.002	64.37%	4,389
Petrifying Meddler + Sage of the Unknowable	Simic Eldrazi	+12%	[+6, +19]%	0.004	55.96%	9,259
Izzet Generatorium + Roil Cartographer	Izzet	+33%	[+16, +51]%	0.004	61.31%	1,525
Electrozoa + Roil Cartographer	Izzet	+29%	[+15, +45]%	0.004	63.19%	2,035
Roil Cartographer + Tune the Narrative	Izzet	+25%	[+13, +39]%	0.004	63.92%	3,578
Bespoke Battlewagon + Izzet Generatorium	Jeskai	+47%	[+24, +75]%	0.005	57.93%	813
Breaker of Creation + Path of Annihilation	Simic Eldrazi	+22%	[+10, +36]%	0.005	67.61%	2,180

Pair		Archetype	Odds	95% CI	q	Pair WR	Games
Path of Annihilation + Warped Tusker		Gruul Eldrazi	+24%	[+12, +37]%	0.006	64.85%	2,384
Basking Broodscale + Titans' Vanguard		Gruul Eldrazi	+19%	[+10, +30]%	0.006	65.10%	3,630
Breaker of Creation + Snapping Voidcraw		Simic Eldrazi	+15%	[+7, +24]%	0.006	59.98%	5,232

9 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pairs whose interaction is significantly negative ($q \leq 0.10$): they win less often when drawn together than their separate effects predict.

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	Pair WR	Games
Crabomination + Eldrazi Repurposer	Simic Eldrazi	-49%	[-66, -25]%	52.14%	140
Crabomination + Etherium Pteramander	Rakdos Zombies	-33%	[-45, -19]%	59.86%	563
Aether Revolt + Skoa, Embermage	Boros	-30%	[-43, -13]%	43.74%	423
Signature Slam + Spawn-Gang Commander	Gruul Eldrazi	-28%	[-38, -17]%	58.98%	963
Eldrazi Linebreaker + Signature Slam	Gruul Eldrazi	-28%	[-42, -10]%	57.18%	383
Aerie Auxiliary + Phlage, Titan of Fire's Fury	Boros	-26%	[-37, -13]%	63.91%	884
Crabomination + Cranial Ram	Rakdos Zombies	-26%	[-36, -15]%	62.95%	1,679
Unfathomable Truths + Unstable Amulet	Izzet	-24%	[-36, -11]%	58.90%	927
Crabomination + Petrifying Meddler	Dimir	-23%	[-36, -8]%	62.73%	644
Aerie Auxiliary + Rosecot Knight	Selesnya	-21%	[-31, -10]%	50.60%	1,249

10 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. Each archetype is described first by its core: the cards that are played in most of its decks, characteristic of it and connected to the rest of the deck. Bombs are listed separately because they win on their own and are worth taking (and often splashing) whatever the shell. Synergy claims are deliberately conservative: only pairs that survive a false-discovery-controlled interaction test are reported, with their effect size and confidence interval, so the short pair list is a feature of honest statistics rather than a lack of interplay between the cards.